

>Setting up a Printer in Linux

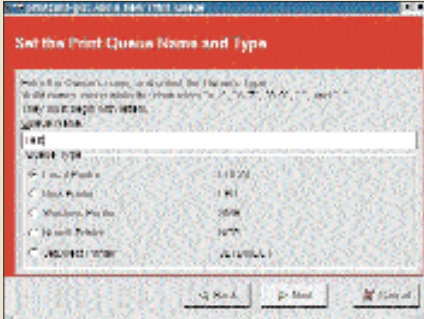
To set up a printer, just go to the KDE Control Panel, select Printer Configuration, enter the root password and in the printconfig-gui dialog box, click on the New icon.

This brings up the Add a New Print Queue wizard. Click on Next. Enter the Printer name and select the Local Printer option. Click on Next, and you will be able to see the printer. If you cannot see the

printer, click on Rescan Devices. If it still doesn't appear in the table, click on the Custom Device tab.

In the Question dialog box, enter /dev/lp0, which is the default device set-

ting for most printers. Click on OK and you will be able to see the printer added to the queue. Now click on Next and select the printer driver from the list. Click on Next again and then Finish. The printer is added. Fire a print to see if it works.



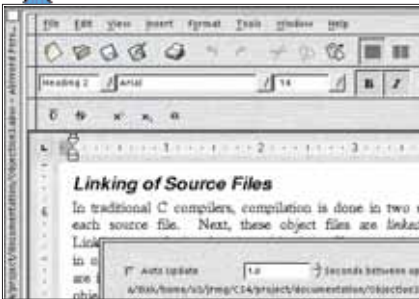
Create a shortcut to your printer



Upon her word

From the Microsoft stable, my mother hates just one software: Microsoft Word. She absolutely blows her top at the 'grammatical intrusions' and generally seems irritated when working with Microsoft Word, but she's used to it. I'd got her Notepad earlier but she started sending mails with too many mistakes. Now I've got her AbiWord.

KWord is a good word processor but can't perform too well when it comes to output quality, especially in comparison to Microsoft Word. This is where AbiWord steps in. In terms of usage and output, it is very similar to MS Word. My mom is quite happy with it.



AbiWord can be found in **Start Application > Applications > AbiWord**. And I didn't forget to create a shortcut for it on the desktop.

Movies with Tux

My mom likes movies—it doesn't matter how they play or what software they play on as long as they play fine and open on

the entire screen. I let her choose between KDE Media Player and GTV MPEG Player, and left both the icons on the desktop, saying 'Movies Here'. Just in case you are thinking of doing the same for your mom, remember you need to have Gnome installed for using the GTV MPEG Player.

A note for the DivX guys too: Default media players such as KDE Media Player do not support DivX. You have to download DivX and install it on your Linux box before you can watch all those wonderful files. Download it from <http://mpeglib.sourceforge.net>.

Uncompress the .gzip file using the **gunzip** command at shell. Now extract the .tar file using the command. For



Why Mom Needs Linux

As a Linux user and developer you might find it much more productive to have your mom use Linux than Windows. Here are four reasons why:

- " Saves the trouble of setting up a dual partition.
- " In Linux, user privileges and rights are well-defined and there's no way your mom or anybody can access your files or other applications without the appropriate rights.
- " You can have an application running simultaneously under your username as well as your mom's.
- " Run multiple processes in the background while your mom works.

example, if the file name is mpeglib_divxplugin-0.1.8.tar, then the command is

tar xvf mpeglib_divxplugin-0.1.8.tar

Change to the created directory using **cd mpeglib_divxplugin-0.1.8**

Now use the following commands to install DivX:

**./configure
make
make install
make clear**

All a good movie now needs is a good set of speakers. There's nothing better than an old classic in the afternoons for your mom to unwind after a hard day's work.

For any musical family, XMMS is the audio player I would recommend. It is Winamp's clone for Linux, easy-to-use, and has the same shortcuts as Winamp. My mom knows Winamp pretty well enough (she can play, stop, choose songs, and increase volume) and appeared comfortable with XMMS. Of course, I added a shortcut on the desktop.

Autorunning CDs

Most Linux flavours do not allow autorun of CDs, not as of now at least. Download and install a utility called

Autorun, a CD mounting utility that allows you to autorun CDs. You'll get it at <http://sourceforge.net/projects/autorun>.

I had to do a bit of tweaking after installing Autorun since autorunning CDs is usually available only if you log in as root. To allow other users to autorun CDs, add user, exec options to the CD-ROM line in /etc/fstab. This ought to get all those autorun CDs zipping.

Mom's a sport

Though my mom is not much into games, I have known a few mates whose moms are avid gamers! Most Linux flavours come bundled with loads of games. While installing Linux I added games to the install list and got in a couple of games such as *Tetris*, *Mahjongg*, *Poker*, *Minesweeper*, etc.

Now my mom can do all her computing chores by herself and doesn't even need my help for entertainment. I kept a soft toy, a Tux-like penguin actually, on the monitor and she hasn't taken it away till now. I'm telling you she's in love with Tux and he's here to stay. ■

ANIL PATRICK R.